Mugasha II (1980)

Performed by Habib Suliman

Translated and edited by P.S.

This second version of Mugasha by Habib Suliman is no less remarkable a performance than that recorded by the bard 30 years earlier. It is included here because it is an equally entertaining telling of the mythic tale by the virtuoso bard. Based on conversations with Prof. M.M. Mulokozi, I think that Habib's 1980 version represents the evolution of the bard's art toward a more mimetic and theatrical form. While some of the rich stanzaic forms of the 1950 version remain in 1980, creative focus seems to be more on the elaboration and colorful depiction of events. The bard omits entirely the first episode -- Mugasha's difficult birth, structured in the 1950 version as a single, intricate poetic figure composed of about 80 interrelated lines -- and expands and elaborates the riotous wedding feast with its uninvited aquatic guests. Habib performed this in 1980 at the court of Mukama Gabriel Rugabandana, who continued to promote and protect Haya culture even after he and other kings of Hayaland lost official political recognition in 1961.

"I am Mugasha-a-a-a."
He said, "Come grab hold . . . The water is swallowing me,
Mugasha!"

That day, my lords, we fell into a quandary.
All nine women there fell into a quandary.
Confounded they were.

That day, Nyatende and Nyambubi:
A woman there they call Nyatende,
A sister of Nyambubi.
The woman they call Nyatende,
Sister of Nyambubi

That day she spoke to Nyambubi,
"Child of my mother, ancestral spirit
Help me place my feet for mercy's sake
So I can grab my child!"
She said, "So I can grab my child.
This very day, I will.

"You know that if an only child dies,
It kills the one that bore it;
It brings us haunting;
It returns and brings bad dreams as well.

Mugasha's mother's sister waded out in the water.
It grabbed her to the nipples of her breasts.
The woman backed out buttocks first that day.

The woman raised her hand as though she laid a curse.
I saw her speak to Mugasha.
She said, "I am not the one who gave you birth,
O dear, not I who pushed for you.
Let not the water swallow me, Mugasha!"
The woman backed out buttocks first that day.

"Mugasha inye-e-e-e."
Ahi, "Mwije munkwaate amaizi gandya, Mugasha!"

Kil' ekyo twagw' omu tangaalo waitu inywe.
Abakazi mwenda bona bagw' omu bitangaalo.
Bashobelwa.

Kil' ekyo Nyatende na Nyambubi:
Akab' aliw' omukazi mbamweeta Nyatende,
Mulumuna Nyambubi iyo-o.
Omukazi mbamweeta Nyatende,
Mulumuna Nyambubi.

Kil' ekyo yagambila Nyambubi,
Ati, "Mwaana wa maawe, muchwezi gw' omwaitu
Mbeel' amagulu ob' otaileho kazilo
Kankwaat' omwaana wange 'nye iyo-o."
Ahi, "Kankwaat' omwaana wange,
Kil' ekya mbwenu inye.

"Nomany' omwaana yakuf' ali omoi:
Ait' ayakuzaile;
Atuleteil' enchweke;
Agaluka atuleteil' amahunga."

Nyinento Mugasha, maawe, yasabal' omu maizi.
Gamukwaat' omu nnatwa z' amabele.
Omukazi kil' ekyo yagaluky' ekinyainyio.

Omukazi yaimuky' omukono nk' alikuteega.
Nkabona yagambila Mugasha
Ahi, "Mwaana wange, tiinye nkuzaile,
Kyonkya kazilo, tiinye nkusindikiile.
K' amaizi gatandya Mugasha!"
Omukazi yagaluky' ekinyainyio kil' ekyo.

NOTES

1 The bard begins his story at the first of the two trials that reveal the identity of Mugasha's mother. He omits Mugasha's miraculous and difficult birth and early childhood — events on which he lavished, in his earlier performance, almost 200 lines of poetry sung with about 60 of his breaths. In this version he gives less emphasis to the mythic aspects and more to the poetic power of mimesis and comparison. The bard can begin at this point because 1) most people already know the story, and 2) this genre and especially the Mugasha ballad can have various ways of introducing the obligatory, genre-defining episode — the Call — Mugasha's confrontation and mutual swearing with Wamara's daughter.

2 Mugasha, the spirit that controls events on the lake, being swallowed by the lake is a laughable ruse.

4 Nyatende is Mugasha's mother's sister. Nyambubi is his mother, as will become apparent.

5.3 Child of my mother and ancestral spirit are terms of address that convey both intimacy and respect. Mugasha's aunt asks her sister's help in a difficult task.

6 My child! Nyatende asserts untruthfully that Mugasha is hers.

7 This belief about the unsettled nature of a deceased child's spirit is commonly known.

9 Mugasha's aunt's gesture, hand raised with palm outward, usually requests a spirit's help in redressing a wrong.

8 Mugasha's childless aunt starts out as though she will succeed in becoming known as his mother, but her dedication is not sufficient and she fails. The women argue.

POETIC STANZAS

2.1-3: 2.1-3.1: stanza in **aab** formed by contrast between lines that contain "fall" + "into a quandary" (**a**'s: 2.1, 3) and a single one word line, "they were confounded" (**b**: 3.1)

4-5: 4-5.1: compound stanza in **abb**, 1 + 2 + 2, formed by contrast between couplets substantially repeated whose lines alternatingly contain one of two names (**b**'s: 4.1-4.2, 5-5.1) and a single line that contains both names (**a**: 4).

5.2-6: 5.2-6.1: compound stanza in **abb**a, 1 + 2 + 2 + 1, by contrast between single lines that begin with "That day" (**a**'s: 5.2, 6.1) and couplets that cohere respectively by enjambment and repetition (**b**'s: 5.3-5.4, 5.5-6)

7-7: 7-7.3: stanza in **abb**b by contrast between lines that begin with 3rd person singular verbs in the habitual aspect (**b**'s: 7.1, 7.2, 7.3) and a single line that begins with a second person singular verb in the present continuative.

8-8: 8-8.2: stanza in **aba** by parallel lines (**a**'s: 8, 8.2) with opposing verbs "she set out" and "she returned" contrasted with a single verb initial line (**b**: 8.1).

NOTES

13.4 A forgetful debtor avoids looking his creditor in the eye.

18 Kagolo's praise alludes to his hot-headed and warlike behavior, which spirit mediums embody when they are possessed by him.

18.1 *Dry words* are strong and effective, as opposed to 'wet' words, which are weak.

18.2 Stiff Elbows probably reflects his demeanor as a possessing spirit; it seems to reinforce in gestural language his extreme and immoderate behavior.

18.5 The water oracle (*Byantabuzi*) is associated with this spirit (its name comes from *oku-tabula*, "to make water bubble up or forth"). Byantabuzi also echoes the name of the place where Kagolo acquired his characteristic way of talking (l. 136.3).

19 *Drank it, spilled it, built it, burned it*, refer to the episodes of myths about Kagolo and his grandfather Wamala.

13 Squatting or sitting with the knees raised is women's characteristic posture for several gender-related acts: giving birth, having sex, urinating, cooking at the hearth, and doing agricultural labor.

POETIC STANZAS

12.3-13: 12.3-13.4: stanza in **ab**b**a**a**b**, 1 + 2 + 2 + 1, by contrast between lines that contain a 3rd person plural verb (**a**'s: 12.3, 13.2, 13.3) and lines that are composed of praisenames (**b**'s: 13, 13.1, 13.4).

13.5-14: 13.5-14.3: compound stanza in **abb**, 2 + 2 + 2, by contrast between a single couplet that coheres by parallelism (**a**: 13.5-13.6) and couplets that each cohere internally by enjambment and are both interrogatives composed as subordinate clause introduced by adverbial marker *Ka/* question introduced by emphatic marker Nka (**b**'s: 14-14.1, 14.2-14.3).

20-23: 20-23.2: compound stanza in **aab**, 4 + 3 + 1, by initial linegroups (**a**'s: 20-21.1, 22-23.1) that cohere internally by enjambment and are composed similarly as scene-setting address or aside (20-21.1, 22)/ parallel quoted speech introduced by locutive (21, 23)/ final parallel line (21.1, 23.1), contrasted with a single finalizing line (**b**: 23.2) that has an initial negative verb.

Since Mugasha had no one to take him from the lake,
That day he got out from the lake himself.
He got back in the canoe.

And when he reached the shore,
He found them fighting over fish,

People of squatting and of iron,
You know, *people of hoes ruled by* kabagala,
They came to fight.
They quarreled over an *enkuyu* fish,
Big eyes skyward like a forgetful debtor.

The one said, "I am the one who gave him birth,"
She said, "I am the one who pushed for him."
The other said, "If you gave birth to him, then why
When he fell into the water did you not go grab him?
The one said, "And why
When you went to grab him, did you back out buttocks first?"

15 Ewewe yo o

It happened that Wamala was there that day.
He showed them the copper spear of Kagolo,
Missile that causes envy,
Dry words spoken in fury
Stiff elbows,
All adorned in beads except the palm,
Of the left-handers,
Of the water oracle;
He drank it–he spilled it,
He built it–he burned it,
Pouncer on warriors.

20 Wamala said, "You nine women, as you are here,
Make a judgement, my children:"
He said, "If a warrior woman steps forward and spears Mugasha and kills him,
I will give her nine children."
And to show how much they want to reproduce, my lord,
The *People of the Peaceful-one*:
Mugasha's mother's sister said, "Let me spear Mugasha.
I'll kill him.
They'll give me the nine children.
These cannot be compared to the single child of Nyambubi."

Mugasha kayabuzil' ow'okumwihy' omu nyanja,
Kil' ekyo yalug' omu nyanja.
Yagaluk' omu bwato

Kabwagobil' aha mwaalo
Baitanil' esamaki

Aba Lyabandame na Bwooma
Nomany' ab' emfuka itwaalwa Kabagala
Baija kulwaana.
Mbaitanil' Enkuyu,
Bilali bya kahunga.

Ogw' ati, "Ninye muzaile."
N'ogw' ati, "Ninye musindikile."
Ogw' ati, "Komuzaile, olwo yagw' omu nyanja,
Nk' otagya kukumkwaata?"
Ogw' ati, "Kawagya kumukwaata,
Nka wagaluky' ekinyainyio?"

15 Ewewe yo-o

Akashangwa aliwo Wamala kil' ekyo.
Yabah' eichumu ly' omulinga elya Kagolo.
Elya Luhuuba lwa Kachubya
Butoto bwa Kyoomya
Ow' enkokola zabaile igandami
Buhunzile bwoona busigaiz' akaganja
Bwa nyin' emosho,
Kabyantabuuzi;
Agunywana agushesha;
Agombeka agookya,
Lutumbika manzi.

20 Wamala ati, "Inyw' abakazi mwend' okwo muli aha Mbalamule baana bange:"
Ati, "Aluge' omukazi emanzi achumite Mugasha amwite

Ndamuha abaana mwenda."
Mala kumanya bagonz' oluzaalo, waitu,

Nyinento Mugasha ahi, "Kanchumite Mugasha mwite.

Balamp' abaana mwenda.
Tibalikwigana mwan' omo wa Nyambubi."

POETIC STANZAS

25-25: 25-25.3: stanza in **aabb** formed by contrast between couplets that cohere as 3rd person singular narrative (**a**'s: 25-25.2) and as negative, quoted, 1st person speech (**b**'s: 25.2-25.3).

26.1-30: 26.1-30.1: stanza in **a**aa**b**b**x**aa**b** formed by lines that contain ethical statements (**a**'s: 26.1-26.3, 29-30) contrasted with lines that are composed as "they gave" + fishname [/ praisenames] (**b**'s: 27-28, 30.1); note intervening line (**x**: 28).

32-32: 32-32.3: stanza in **aa**a**b** formed by contrast between lines whose initial 3rd person verb is near past (**a**'s: 32-32.2) and a single line whose initial 3rd person verb is distant past

35.1-37: 35.1-37.5: verse in **aba** formed by contrast between stanzas formed in **aba** (a's: 35.1-36.2, 37.2-37.5) and a couplet (**b**: 37-37.1) that coheres by parallel use of 3rd plural near past verbs; the first stanza is formed in **aa**a**ba** by contrast between 1st person singular verb initial lines that express desire (**a**'s: 35.1-36, 36.2) and a single line that comprises a dependent clause (**b**: 36.1); the second stanza is formed in **a**a**ba** by contrast between lines composed as verb initial + placenames (**a**'s: 37.2, 37.3, 37.5) and a single line composed as placenames alone (**b**: 37.4).

E wewe e

When she raised the spear, Nyambubi leapt up from below.
She whirled and grabbed her,
And she said, "Why should this thing kill my child?
I didn't cause its barrenness."

That day those present said, "Nyambubi, you win the dispute.
No woman would kill a child she gave birth to.
Nyambubi, the child is yours."
Then they gave her a large fish,
An *enkuyu*, *big eyes skyward like a forgetful debtor*.
Of the woman Nyatende, sister of Nyambubi
They said–women, I tell you, sad but true–
"Mother's sisters are people with ill wishes.
That woman, don't leave her empty handed."
They give her little *obukeije* and *enkolongo* fish

E wewe e Mugasha

He left, having found his mother, who gave him birth.
He returned to Great Lake Lweru, the *trapper* did.
He spent four-and-four-make-eight days there
He then called Rushing-water.

E-e, of the lake, you-u
"You, Rushing-water of the lake,
Whirling one, child of limbtwister,
You pulled out the fish lines."

He said, "This very day I am wishing:
I would visit all the lakeshore landings
To the mouths of rivers I would go."
He said, "I would go to the mouth
Where the Kagera opens onto Great Lake Lweru.
I would pass by there to Ishulaine Bugunda."

The commotion they created pulled out all the fish traps on the lake.
That day they paddled hard.

E wewe-e

Kayalyetwekile, Nyambubi yalug' aha nsi.

Yaguluka yamukwata.
Ahi, "Kitanyitila mwaana!
Tiinye nakileteile bugumba."

Kil' ekyo ababaile bali 'ho bahi, "Nyambubi nosing' omushango
Taliw' omukazi alaisile mwaana amuzaile.
Nyambubi omwaana wawe inywe."
Aho bamuha enfulu mpango
Enkuyu *bilali bya kahuunga*.
Omukazi Nyatende, mulumuna Nyambubi --
Bati, "Abakazi nkugambile kazilo:
Banyinento bantu bagil' emilaamo
Omukaz' ogu mutakumwiyaho busha."
Bamuh' obukeije n' enkolongo.

E wewe-e Mugasha

Yasiga yabona nyina alikumuzaala.
Yashub' omu nyanj' empango nka Lweru *Njwenge*.
Yamalayo ebilo bina na bina munana.
Akeeta Mushoke.

E-e, Gwa nyanja, iwe-e
"Iwe Mushoke gw' aha nyanja
Izilinga lya nyakamyookya
Okasik' emigonjo.

Ahi, "Kil' ekya mbwenu kazilo
Ningonza nkyal' emyalo yoona.
Ngy' omwa mashangaano 'nye."
Ahi, "Ningonza ngy' omwa mashangaano,
Mbali Kagera etela Lweru.
Ndabeyo ngob' omwa Ishulaine Bugunda."

Basik' emigonjo boona.

Kil' ekyo babuga bwangu.

NOTES

40 Lyanyaibungo was gathering straw to place on the floor of a dwelling. Work of this kind comes under the category of “to make things pleasing,” a knowledge especially associated with marriageable young women.

42 Silent runner praises lightning, which in traditional belief is silent and relatively harmless; thunder is thought to make noise and do damage.

43 Nshungu is a strong seasonal wind that brings cloud formations resembling the long horns of Ankole cattle.

POETIC STANZAS

41-46: 41-46.1: stanza in **ab**bb**a**a**b**babbb formed by contrast between lines composed as [child] + "surprised by" + nature spirit (**a**'s: 41, 42.1, 43, 45) and lines composed as praisenames (**b**'s: 41.1, 41.2, 42, 44, 44.1, 45.1, 46, 46.1).

47-48: 47-48.1: compound stanza in **abb**, 1 + 2 + 2, formed by contrast between nearly identical couplets that cohere internally semantically (**b**'s: 47.1-47.2, 48-48.1) and a single line that begins with a direct object.

48.2-48: 48.2-48.4: stanza in **aab** formed by contrast between lines that have an initial verb (**a**'s: 48.2, 48.3) and a single line that has no verb (**b**: 48.4).

He turned at Kishanje village of Kalasha at Mutailenge's,
He went to Ibebe Bweza's.
Lubafu at the waters of Nyamataba at Kanyabagwa beach.
He landed at Kyahu Island of Nyakwezi.

He cast his eyes toward Bitterness Marsh.
It was then he saw eight maidens.
And the ninth was Lyanyaibungo, *bull of the kalaito*.

The child happened to be gathering straw–so far, eight bundles.
The ninth she held in her hand.
The tenth she pressed underfoot.

The child was surprised by whistling-wind,
Blower of cold,
I never miss a doorway.
Silent runner, lightning-flash,
The child was surprised by thunder (Kaiyula).
She was surprised by winged *nshungu* wind of Lwabulungu,
Great horns lie back across the shoulders,
Bad news brought by a traveler.
She was surprised by lake-wind, *water-bundler*,

Mwigundu wind of Bitoma village,
Associated with the *swaying-one of Nyante*.

Her gathered straw, the winds flung round and round.
With her Raffia skirt she tried and tried to push the bundles down, my lord,
But without effect.
With her Raffia skirt she tried and tried to push the bundles down,
But without effect.

She sat down on the ground.
She swore, "O my father!
Swaying-one of Nyante."

Yezinga Kishanje kya Kalasha omwa Mutailenge.
Yagy' omwa Ibeebe Bweza.
Lubafu omu ga Nyamataba aha munwa gwa Kanyabagwa.
Yatoonya Kyahu kya Nyakweezi.

Yanag' amaisho omu izinga Bushungu.
Akabona abaisiki munana.
Owa mwenda akaba ali Lyanyaibungo, *Engundu y'akakalaito*.

Omwaana akashangwa yaihya obunyasi ebiganda munana.

Ogwa mwenda agukwete omu byaala
Ogwa ikumi akashangwa agulibatiile.

Omwaana akechula Kiwiwisi,
Ekihuutilizi-mbeho,
Tinsiga mulyango.
Kachwaichwaita Kimyanso,
Omwaana ayechula Kaihyula.
Ayechula Nshungu kapapa ka Lwabulungu,

Bikulembe ebilalila mabega,
Nkulumbi etwalwa mugenzi.
Akechula Munyanja *Nkomaizi Lwasa-bihinda*.
Mwigundu gwa Bitoma (ogw' enkanya),
Ikwatil' Oluyongo lwa Nyante.

[Omwan'] Obunyasi omuyaga gwabunagaanaga
Yebubumbabumba n' akashenshe waitu

Byabula nshai.
Omwaana yebumbabumba n' akashenshe

Byabula nshai.

Yashuntama aha nsi.
Yanaila ahi, "Iwe tata!
Luyongo lwa Nyante."

POETIC STANZAS

50-51: 50-51.1: stanza in **ab**b**ab**bb formed by contrast between lines that comprise and address to the maiden (**a**'s: 50, 50.3) and lines composed as praisenames (**b**'s: 50.1, 50.2, 5.4, 51, 51.1).

50-72: 50-72: verse passage in **abba** formed, with many interpolated lines, around the contrast between speakers, Mugasha's utterances (**a**'s) of proposal (50, 50.3) and oath (69.1-70.1) and the maiden's utterances (**b**'s) of response (53.2, 53.3)) and oath(56-57.2).

52-52: 52-52.3: stanza in **aab** formed by contrast between lines whose main verbs are inflected to accord with "child" (**a**'s: 52, 52.1) and one line whose verb accords with "spit" (**b**: 52.3).

53.2-54: 53.2-54.1: compound stanza in **abb**, 1 + 2 + 2, formed by couplets each composed as second person predication / explication of predication (**b**'s: 53.3-53.4 and 55-55.1:fisherman cannot marry royalty and dried fish stink, respectively) contrasted with a single line of address (**a**: 53.2)

And she had scarcely gotten the words from her mouth,
When suddenly Mugasha appeared.
He said, "Maiden, let me tell you clearly:
I am the only child.
I ended my mother's barrenness.
But now, I would court you. I would marry you.
I am a child of the Kagulamo springs.
He said, *"I am a child of hailstones, of earth tremors,*
I come from the blocker."

The maiden wept. She wailed.
She spat.
Her spittle scattered.

I saw the child press and press her things together.
She sat confounded.

She said, "But, Mugasha, let me tell you clearly, too:
You cannot marry me,
You little fisherman of Ishulaine Bugunda
She said, "Die without issue! You stink!"
That day Mugasha had tied on his cloak of dried minnows.

The maiden on that day,
She said, "Just let me swear something to you, *trapper*"
She said, "Let me tell you this, Mugasha:
Were you to marry me,
I'd as well lie with Kagolo, the child of my own mother,
She said, "*Of the spirit shrine,*
Of the water oracle,"
She said, "*Missile that causes envy,*
Dry words spoken in fury,
Of stiff elbows,
All adorned in beads except the palm,
Of the left-handers
Of the water oracle,
He drank it–he spilled it;
He built it–he burned it,
Pouncer on warriors."
The maiden that day swore to the *trapper*

That day he spoke, the *water-dweller,*
Child of the Kagulamo springs
He said, "And you, *welata*,"
He said, "*Welata, welata*,"
He said, "Rushing-water of the Lake, *(Puller) of Fish-lines*,"
He said, "*Whirling one, child of Limbtwister*,

Mala akashangwa atakahil' omukanwa,
Lyamuleeta Mugasha.
Ahi, "Mwisiki nkugambilege:
Inye ndi mwaan' omoi.
Nkamalila maaw' obugumba.
Kyonka mbwenu nkushelele nkushweele.
Ndi mwaana w' enchulo za Kagulamo."
Ati, "*Ndi wa Lubaale olwa Misisi Engundu,*
Nintemwa omwa Nyamuzinda 'nye."

Omwisiki yachula yabolooga.
Yachw' enyili.
Zatalaaka.

Omwaana nkabona yebumbabumba.
Yaikal' ashobeilwe.

Ahi, "Kyonka Mugasha nkugambilege,
Toshobola kunshweela.
Akajubi k' omwa Ishulaine Bugunda,"
Ahi, "Chwekamu! Nonuuka!"
Kil' ekyo Mugasha akab' ashumikile ebeebo y' obukanda.

Omwisiki kil' ekyo, inywe yo-o
Ahi, "Mala kankwenahilile inye, *Njwenge."*
Ahi, "Nkugambile Mugasha:
Kawakunshweela
Ninkanyiame n' omwaana wa maawe Kagolo,
Ati, "*Komulwanga*,
Ka Byantabuuzi,"
Ahi, "*Luhuuba lwa kachubya*,
Butoto bwa Kyoomya,
Ow' enkokola zabaile igandami,
Buhunzile bwoona busigaiz' akaganja,
Ka nyin' emosho,
Ka Byantabuuzi,
Agunywana agushesha;
Agombeka agyookya,
Lutumbika maanzi."
Omwisiki mbona kil' ekyo yamwenahilila *Njwenge*.

Kil' ekyo yagamba *Ky' omumaizi*,
Omwaana w' enchulo za Kagulamo.
Mulati, "Naiwe welata,"
Ahi, "Welata, welata,"
Ati, "Emisoke nyanja *ly' emigongo*,"
Ati, "*Ezilinga lya Nyakamyooka Kabantende*,

NOTES

71 Habib has softened Mugasha's counter-factual vow to appearing naked from committing maternal incest (*Mugasha I*: 86).

Maiden, and I swear to you, *welata*,"
"Were I *not* to marry you,
I'd undress and show my nakedness, *welata*."

He said,"Rushing-water of the Lake, *(puller) of fish lines*,"
He said, "*Whirling one, child of limbtwister*,
"Go, I'll put them in the king's forecourt, *welata*,
Go, sound my great drum,
They-die But-they've-been-told, *welata*
I'll also put some beer in there to go."

Mwisiki naile nde welata,"
"Wenaba ntakusweile,
Ninkajuule nyabubu, elata."

Ati, "Emisoke nyanja *ly' emigongo*,"
Ati, "*Ezilinga Kamuga Kabantende*,
"Mugye, nzitul' omu kibuga ky' omukama welata,
Mugye mutagalul' engoma yang' empango -
Bafa Mbagambiile welata.
Ngye ntemu amalwa gali kagyenda."

POETIC STANZAS

79-81: 79-81.3: stanza in **aba** formed by single lines that include a drum name (**a**'s: 79, 81.3) contrasted with lines of drum sounds (**b**'s: 79.1-81.2)

82-114: 82-114: passage of lines composed as apperance of nature spirit/ [praisename]/ [quoted self-praise of characterization or boast]/: "you marry her, [Mugasha or his praisename]"

O oh
Wewe eh
E wewe eh
E weh the *trapper*
Eh?

That day they sounded the drum, my lord, They-die
But-they've-been-told
Roaring dididi
Roaring dididi
Roaring dididi
Roaring dididi
Roaring dididi
Roaring dididi
Roaring dididi
Roaring dididi
It spoke, They-die But-they've-been-told, my lord.

First to arrive was *Nkuyu* fish,
Big eyes skyward like a forgetful debtor.
I'll tell you well: Mugasha's men began to attend

First to arrive was *Nkuyu* fish,
Big eyes skyward like a forgetful debtor.
He said, "But Lyanyaibungo, Mugasha
Trapper, they'll give her to you.
You marry her, *trapper*!"

Hippopotamus, *smasher of canoes, elder of the waves,*
Said, "*When I arrive at the home of the* swaying-one of Nyante
I'll block the doorway, trapper."

I saw the crocodile say, "You marry her, Mugasha!
Pangolins say, "You marry her, *trapper*!"
The otters say, "You marry her, Mugasha!"
Obushwaikogoto fishes say, "You marry her, *trapper*!
I saw the *obukeije* fish, the *speeders*.
They say, "That day you marry her, Mugasha!"

Enkolongo fish, *small horns, enkoma mujungwizi,*
Enkolongo said, "*When I sit by the door,*
Whoever passes carelessly,
I'll raise my spine a bit,
And I'll pierce him, Mugasha."
"But should you fail to marry Nyaibungo, Mugasha,
We'd drink at the spearshaft of Ndekezi."

O-oh
Wewe-eh
E wewe-eh
E-weh *Njwenge*
Eh?

Kil' ekyo bagenda bagitagalula, waitu, Bafa Bagambiilwe

Ngu diididi
Ngu diididi
Ngu diididi
Ngu diididi
Ngu diididi
Ngu diididi
Ngu diididi
Ngu diididi
Ngu diididi yo-o
Yalaha Bafa bagambiilwe, waitu.

Ayagobileho mbele ni Nkuyu,
Bilali bya kahuunga -
Nkugambilege: Abashaija ba Mugasha babanza kuhululа.
Ayagobileho mbele ni Nkuyu,
Bilali bya kahuunga.
Ahi, "Kyonkya Lyanyaibungo Mugasha,
Njwenge mbamukuha.
Nomushweela *Njwenge*!"

Enjubu, *Kyatamaato, Mukulu w'amayengo,*
Eti, "Inye kandagoba omwa *Luyongo lwa Nyante,*

Akashasi ninkabunda, *Njwenge*."

Nkabon' Enshambi eti, "Nomushweela, Mugasha!
Ensholobwa ziti, "Nomushweela, *Njwenge*!"
Engonge ziti, "Nomushweela, Mugasha!"
Obushwaikogoto buti, "Nomushweela *Njwenge*!"
Nkabon' Obukeije, *Ibiligisa*.
Buhi, "Kil' eki nomushweela, Mugasha!"

Enkolongo, *Bwembe, enkoma mujungwizi,*
Enkolongo eti, "Kandashuntam' omulyango,
"Alikuletwaaho kubi,
Ninyimukyaaho eihwa ly' aha mugongo,
Nimutunga, Mugasha.
"Kyonka otashweile Nyaibungo, Mugasha,
Twakuganywa aha lubango lwa Ndekezi."

NOTES

105.1 *Drink it at the spearshaft of Ndekezi* is a proverbial expression for committing suicide. The phrase refers to a poison ordeal administered by a medium of the spirit Kimuli.

E wewe eh
E wewe eh
He said, "Now we'd drink at the spearshaft of Ndekezi."
The lungfish said, "You marry her, Mugasha!"

He arose and praised himself, *Kasholobana Ekihumpi*
It said, "But Lyanyaibungo, Mugasha,
Trapper, they'll give her to you.
You marry her, *trapper*"
He arose and praised himself that day, the catfish.
He said, "You marry her, Mugasha!"

Then he arose and spoke, the *ensenene* grasshopper.
He said, *I am* Lwakyenge *and* Bagaza
My head is a straw my foot njulujunga
"I'll fall four-and-four-make-eight days in Kyamutwala
On the ninth day they'll be harvesting in bushel baskets.
"But should you fail to marry Lyanyaibungo, Mugasha,
Trapper, we'd drink at the spearshaft of Ndekezi.

E wewe o o

On that day, poor boy, he arose and praised himself, the Grasshopper.
He said, *I am the sharpening stone*
Lover of the mountain pass
I'll fall for three whole days
The tree of sacrifices you see behind the house of the swaying-one of Nyante,
Muhata, *I'll pull up by the roots*, trapper."

He arose and praised himself on that day, thunder, *essential warrior*,
He said, "*When I strike in the forecourt*,
Then strike behind the house,
He said, "*Some will die*,"
He said, "*Others will merely faint*.
But Lyanyaibungo, Mugasha, *they'll give her to you*.
You marry her, trapper!"

He arose and praised himself on that day,
Whistling-wind, with others, *blower of cold, I do not miss a doorway*
They said, "When we cut banana trees at the swaying-one of Nyante's house, Mugasha,
They'll give her to you. You marry her, trapper!"

Hailstones, child of Earthquake
Said, "On that day you marry her, Mugasha!"

E wewe-eh
E wewe-eh
Ahi, "Mbwenu twakuganywa aha lubango lwa Ndekezi."
Emamba ziti, "Nomushweela *Njwenge*!"

Yaimuka yegambisiliza Kasholobana Ekihumpi
Kiti, "Kyonka Lyanyaibungo, Mugasha,
Njwenge, mbamukuha.
Nomushweela *Njwenge*!"
Yaimuka yegambisiliza kil' ekyo Nshonzi
Ati, "Nomushweela Mugasha"

Akaimuka yagamba Nsenene.
Ahi, "*Inye ndi Lwakyenge nabagaza*
Akatwe misheke akagulu njulujunga,
Ndagw' ebilo bina na bina munana Kyamutwala,
Ekya mwenda kulaba kahunga.
Kyonk' otashweile Lyanyaibungo, Mugasha,
Njwenge, twakuganywa aha lubango Lwa Ndekezi."

E wewe o-o

Kil' ekyo, kazilo, akaimuka yegambisilize Nzige

Ati, "Inye ndi *Lwakamahyolo*,
Lugonz' empalo,
Ndagw' ebilo bishatu byonkai,
Ekigabilo ky'obon' aha nyumanju omwa *Luyongo lwa Nyante*,
Muhata ningisoola Njwenge."

Akaimuka yegambisiliza kil' ekyo, Nkuba *Kanyalumanzi*

Ahi, "Kandatel' omu ilembo,
Nkatel' enyumanju,
Ati, "Abandi bafe,"
Ati, "Abandi bashaalala busha.
Kyonkai Lyanyaibungo Mugasha mbamukuha.
Nomushweela *Njwenge*!"

Yaimuka yegambisiliza kil' ekyo,
Kiwiwisi abalimu *Kihuutilizi-mbeho Tinasiga-mulyango*

Bahi, "Katulayendaga omwa Luyongo lwa Nyante, Mugasha,
Bamukuha. Nomushweela, *Njwenge*!"

Lubale olwa misisi
Ahi, "Kileki nomushweela, Mugasha!"

POETIC STANZAS

117-121: 117-121: compound stanza in **aba**, 3 + 2 + 3, formed by contrast between three lines that repeat fully (**a**'s: 117-118.1, 120-121) and two lines that almost repeat (**b**'s: 119-119.1).

That day, my lord, while we were there
That day he spoke, *the Water-dweller*,
Child of the springs of Kagulamo.
He said, "*Welata*, *welata*."

He said, "Rushing-water of the Lake, *(puller) of fish lines*,
Have you carried them, *welata*?"
They said, "Yes."
"Have you carried them, *welata*?"
They said, "Yes."
"Rushing-water of the Lake, *(puller) of fish lines*,"
He said, "Have you carried them *welata*?"
They said, "Yes."

Aho kil' ekyo, waitu, katwabaile tuliwo
Kil' ekyo mbona nagamba *Ky' omumaizi*,
Omwaana w' enchulo za kagulamo.
Ahi, "Naiwelata welata."

Ati, "Musok' nyanja *ly' emigongo*,
Mutwiile welata?"
Bati, "Eho."
Ahi, "Mutwiile welata?"
Bati, "Eho."
Ati, "Musok' enyanja *ely' emigongo*,"
Ati, "Mutwiile welata?"
Bati, "Eho."

POETIC STANZAS

124.1-143: 124.1-143.1: verse passage composed of questions (**a**'s) and answers (**b**'s) formed into three distinct patterns: **aa**aa**b** (124.1-127); **abab**ababab (128-137); and a pair of mirror stanzas formed in **aabab** (138-140.2 and 141-143.1).

He said, "Rushing-water of the Lake, *(puller) of fish lines*,
Take what's needed for a marriage feast at Wamala's, *welata*.
I don't go to propose.
I go directly to the wedding feast, *welata*."

Rushing-water said, "My lord,"
He said, "When they go to marry at the house of Wamala, *Swaying-one of Nyante*, my lord,"
He said, "They present cattle."
He said, "*Welata*, take hippopotami."
They said, "But my lord, goats?
He said, "We'll take crocodiles."
They say, "A hunting dog?"
He said, "Take an otter."
They said, "An iron bell?"
He said, "A tortoise."
They said, "A leash?"
He said, "A *luzilamili* snake."
They said, "A braided collar?"
He said, "*Msuliti ashweela nyali awelata*"

They said, "My lord, and when we've found these things . . ."
They said, "A maiden of the hafted knife to enter the feast?"
He said, "Take an eel."
They said, "An old woman to block the way?"
He said, "Take a *kasolobana* fish."

They said, "My lord, and when we've found these things . . ."
"Women to sing keening songs?"
He said, "Take lungfish."
"An elder to make the speech?"
He said, "Take an *enkolongo* fish."

Ati, "Musok' enyanja *ely' emigongo*,
Mukwaat' ebyokutaha amagenyi bwe Wamala, welata.

Tinja kuselela nde.
Ninyija kutaha amagenyi goluwelata."

Mushoke ati, "Waitu,"
Ahi, "Kabagya kushweela omwa Wamala,
Luyongo lwa Nyante, waitu,"
Ahi, "Bajug' ente."
Ati, "Welata mukwaat' enjubu."
Bahi, "Waitusi, embuzi y' entaama?"
Ahi, "Tutwaal' enshambi."
Bati, "Embwa ya Ilungu?"
Ahi, "Mutwaal' engonge."
Bati, "Ekyooma?"
Ahi, "Msema Kaiseikogoto."
Bati, "Omuguha?"
Ahi, "Luzilamili."
Bati, "Ebyambalo?"
Ahi, "Msuliti ashweela nyali awelata."

Bahi, "Waitu ebyo katwabibona,"

Bahisi, "Omwisiki w' omuholo omutahi w' amagenyi?"

Ahi, "Mukwaat' enshonzi."
Bati, "Omukaikulu w' olukinga?"
Ahi, "Mukwaate kasolobana ekiuky' ewelata."

Bahi, "Waitu ebyo katwabibona,"

Bahisi, "Abakazi b'okutel' empundu?."
Ahi, "Mukwaat' emamba."
"Omugulusi w'okuteel' omushango?"
Ahi, "Mukwaat' enkolongo."

NOTES

149 The frog's song and the events it alludes to apparently come from a folktale, but I have not been able to find the one.

POETIC STANZAS

150-161: 150-161: song (perhaps quoted from a folktale) composed in three repeated verses (150-153, 154-157, 158-161) each formed as **abab** by contrast between lines that contain nouns (**a**'s: 150, 152, 154, 156, 158, 160) and lines that contain only verbs (**b**'s: 151, 153, 155, 157, 159, 161).

Wewe wewe
Wo o
Ewe we

Wamala, *swaying-one of Nyante*,
In the forecourt he stood confounded.
He saw in the forecourt, poor man . . .
That day he was surprised by frogs, jumping and jumping.
They sang, "They'll tell of this, they'll tell of this."
They said, "They'll tell of this, they'll tell of this."

They said, "What did I tell you, *father of grunters*?
Release me, and I'll release you.
What did I tell you, bloodbrother of mine?
Release me, and I'll release you.

Yo o *father of grunters*,
Release me,
E eh Bloodbrother of mine,
Release me, and I'll release you."

They said, "What did I tell you, *father of grunters*?
Release me, and I'll relea . . .
E eh bloodbrother of mine,
Release me, and I'll release you.

And my lord, when he went and looked into the reception room,
Wamala, *swaying-one of Nyante*,
He saw the *enkolongo* fish.
It had sat in the reception room and was making its speech.

Wewe-wewe
Wo-o
Ewe-we

Wamala *Luyongo lwa Nyante*
Omu ilembo aikala ashobeilwe, inywe.
Akabon' omu ilembo, kazilo...
Kil' ekyo yechul' ebikele mbichokachoka.

Bikwete, "Balikagana, balikagana."
Biti, "Balikagana, balikagana."

Biti, "Nkakugambilaki, Ishe Lukimbilaho?
Nteguulula ndikuteguulula.
Nkakugambilaki, munywanyi wange?
Nteguulula ndikuteguulula.

Yo-o Ishe Lukimbila,
Nteguulula,
E-eh munywani wange,
Nteguulula ndikuteguulula."

Biti, "Nkakugambilaki, Ishe Lukimbilaho?
Nteguulula ndikute-e
E-eh munywani wange,
Nteguulula ndikuteguule-e.

Mala waitu kayagiile kuleb' omu ibanga,

Wamala *Luyongo lwa Nyante*,
Akabon' enkolongo.
Eshuntamile omu ibanga neteel' omushango.

NOTES

179 The house Habib refers to is the traditional Musonge, large, dome-shaped, bamboo-framed, thatched with grass, and apparently very flammable.

182 The maiden of the hafted knife is a young girl who accompanies the speech-making, spear-bearing elder. Her cultural butterfat becomes natural slime by the power of Wamala.

POETIC STANZAS

167-186: 167-186.3: passage composed of four linegroups (167-168.1, 169-175.2, 176-181.2, 182-187.3) each composed thematically as (a) fish fulfills wedding role (167, 169 and 173, 176, 182 and 185 - in the second and the fourth linegroups this element is repeated; (b) description of wedding role (167.1, 170-172.2, 177 183-84) (c) transformantion of form (168, 174-175.1, 178-181.1, 186-186.2); (d) "The power of Wamala" (168.1, 175.2, 181.2, 186.3).

Now, my lord, what did Wamala begin to do then?
To transform Mugasha's things
By his power.

He saw *nlolongo* had sat and was making a speech.
Nkolongo's spear placed on his shoulder to enter the feast,
Became a spine stuck to his back,
By the power of Wamala.

The elder woman who blocks the way became a *kasolobana ekihumpi* fish.
You know how they enter a feast:
One elder woman goes to the back room, another, to the front.
They answer one another singing.
They toss songs back and forth in cackling voices.
One they do: "Mine is a spoiled child.
When she sees the fallow land she cultivates."
(Audience:) Mercy yes
The elder woman was a *kasolobana ekihumpi* fish,
And long ago the *ekihumpi* had a mouth like other fish.
Now as she sat to cackle out those words,
Her mouth stretched longer,
By the power of Wamala.

The women who sang the keening songs were lungfish.
Long ago lungfish were white-white-white like cloth.
But the house they sat in was a "Let's pray to see at dawn he's made it through the night."
Below was kerosene.
Above was gasoline.
It confounds one.
Now the soot that dripped down,
Was what stuck spots on them,
By the power of Wamala

The maiden of the hafted knife was catfish.
And you know the maiden of the hafted knife–
They rub more fat on her than on the bride herself.

They place the hafted knife on her. She sits motionless.
The maiden was an eel.
The slipperyness of the fat they spread on her,
Now means when you go to grasp a catfish,
You first must pat a bit of mud,
By the power of Wamala.

Mbwenu waitu aho Wamala yabanza kugilaki?
Kuhindula ebintu bya Mugasha,
Obushobola bwe.

Akabon' enkolongo eshuntamile neteel' omushango.
Nkolongo eichumu lyoyaizile ataile aibega kutaha amagenyi,
Nilyo ihwa lyagikweet' amugongo,
Olwo obushobola bwa Wamala.

Omukaikulu owolukinga akaba ali kasolobana ekihumpi.

Mumubona okwo bataha amagenyi:
Omukaikulu akagya amulyango now' amwanya.

Mbaholoolana.
Mbachwa ebizina ebyokutetelela.
Ebyobagila: "Owange (ajanganayo) ajaangalaile.
Kalibona enshambu alilima."
- Inya kazilo -
Omukaikulu ogwo akaba ali kasoloban' ekihumpi,
Mala n' ekihumpi eila kyagiilag' omunwa nk' enfulu ezindi.
Mbwenu mbali yaikaile kuteteelela ebigamb' ebyo,
Nyi' omunwa gwalabiile kulaiya,
Obushobola bwa Wamala.

Abakazi b' empundu bakaba bali mamba.
Eil' emamba zayelaga teiteite nk' emyendo.
Enju bakaba bashuntamile omuli "Tumuombe kuleba nkabulakya akalaalamu bukakya."
Ahansi aliyo amajuta g' etaala
Eigulu aliyo petrol
Nashobelwa omuntu.
Mbwenu omunyali kagwagitonyeile,
Nikyo kyagikwes' obugondo,
Obushobola bwa Wamala.

Omwisiki w' omuholo akaba ali Nshonzi.
Mala mubona omwisiki w' omuholo,
Bamulagaza bamutaho amajuta kushaag' omugole kandi alikushweelwa.
Bamutaho omuholo. Atendeela.
Omwisiki akaba ali Enshonzi.
Okutelela kw' amajut' agobabaile bamusiigile,
Namambwenu koija kukwaat' enshonzi,
Okalakala akashaabo,
Obushobola bwa Wamala.

POETIC STANZAS

190-212: 190-212.2: verse passage composed of three linegroups (190-198, 199-203, 204-212.3) that form an **aab** pattern; each linegroup composed as (a) Mugasha sends a nature spitrit (190-190.1, 199, 204) (b) the spirit's action briefly described (191, 200, 205-206) (c) aside commenting on the effects of such an action (192-193, 201, 207) (d) elaborated description of element's action (194-197, 202-202.2, 207-211) (e) Wamala's response (198, 203, 212-212.4); the linegroups create a pattern of **aab** by contrast principally between simple refusals and an elaborate quasi-acceptance (e: 198, 203 and 121-212.3, respectively), and also between single lines of terse narrative and a pair of lines of direct discourse that cohere by enjambment (b: 191, 200 and 206-207, respectively).

Wo o

Wamala stood there confounded.
He said, "I cannot give a daughter to the fisherman from Ishulaine Bugunda.
I am Wamala, *swaying-one of Nyante*,
My child cannot be married to a fisherman.

Then Mugasha sent Whistling-wind, among others,

They cut down banana palms . . . without effect.
You hear them say, "In such-and-such a place, the wind has cut them, but in another place, it has cut even
And in still another place, it merely passed through.
Now on that day, no wind came to the neighbors.
To the neighbors it did come but passed through gently, gently.
At Wamala's house,
Even plantain sprouts of bottle length were felled.
He still refused, the *swaying-one of Nyante*.

He sent thunder, *essential warrior*.
He struck in the forecourt, he struck behind the house.
Do you remember what it's like when thunder strikes at your neighbor's?
Thunder struck at Wamala's in the forecourt; he struck behind the house.
Some died, others merely fainted.
They splashed water on them and they revived.
But Wamala still refused, saying "I cannot marry my daughter to a fisherman."

He sent hailstones, child of earthquake.
Wamala said,"My child,"
He said, "The way he goes to war amazes."
Can you imagine what a hailstone big enough to grab is like?

Now Wamala stood there
Covered from feet to chest.
Above was only head and arms,
His legs and clothing sunk in hailstones.

He said, "Get a slave girl. Dress her as a bride.
Let the *bull of Nyambubi* marry her."
He said, "But he will not marry my daughter, Lyanyaibungo,
Bull of the kalaito."

Wo-o

Wamala yaikala ashobeilwe.
Ati, "Tinakusiigila mujubi w' omwa Ishulaine Bugunda nye.
Inye ndi Wamala *Luyongo lwa Nyante*,
Kyonka omwaana wange tiyakushweelwa mujubi."

Aho Mugasha yasindika Kiwiwisi abalimu,
Kihutilizi-mbeho Tinsiga-mulyango.
Bayendagana. Byabulansha.
Muhulila mbakigamba bati, "Bunanka gwatema kyonka bunanka gwatema muno.
Ahandi gwalabaalabamu
Mbwenu kil' ekyo taliho muyaga kugya omu batani.
Omu bataani gukagyayo gwalabaalabamu mpola mpola.

Kyonka omwa Wamala,
Omwaana gw' engemu ogulikwiigan' echupa gukagwa.
Yayanga *Luyongo lwa Nyante*.

Yasindika Nkuba *Kanyalumanzi*.
Yateel' omu ilembo, yateel' enyumanju.
Naiwe ijuka enkuba kuteela omwa mwaatani wawe okwo wakushana.
Enkuba Wamala ekateel' omu ilembo, yateel' enyumanju.

Abandi baafa, abandi baashalala
Basheshela amaizi, bahimbuuka.
Kyonka Wamala akanga ati, "Tinakusiigila mujubi"

Yasindika Lubali olwa Misisi.
Wamala ahi, "Bojo,"
Ati, "Yatabaala ashobeize."
Naiwe ijuka eibale limo lyenjula kulikwaata.

Mbwenu Wamala akeemelela.
Gamweema amagulu kushohola omu kifuba.
Eigulu yasigazayo omutwe n' emikono.
Amagulu n' emyendo byatobela omu mabale ag' enjula

Ahi, "Mwiyemu omuzaan' omo, mumulagaze.
Agy' amushweele *engundu ya Nyambubi*."
Ahi, "Kyonka tiyakushweela muhala wange, Lyanyaibungo,
Engundu y' akakalaito."

POETIC STANZAS

213-221: 213-221.1: three stanzas formed in **aab** by lines that cohere by parallelism created by verb inflection and word order contrasted with single lines composed differently; the first such stanza (213-217) is formed in **aa**a**b**(b) by contrast between lines that have a subject in initial position followed by an adverbial past perfect verb (**a**'s: 213, 214, 215) and a single line that also begins with a subject but whose verb is inflected differently (**b**: 216); the stanza is then ® MDUL¯re-finalized by a line that has a verb in initial position (b: 217); the second stanza (218-219.1) is formed in **aab** by contrast between lines of narration that cohere by initial verbs with similar inflections (**a**'s: 218, 219) contrasted with a single line of quoted speech (**b**:219.1); the third stanza in the group (220.1-221.1) is formed in **aab** by contrast between lines of narration that begin with a double verb formation (**a**'s:220.1, 222) and a single line of quoted speech (**b**: 221.1)

When they left the child on the threshold by the wicker screen,
When hippo looked and said, "She's not the one we saw in the marsh!"
When hippo spoke to her gruffly, "Ha! ha! ha! hu! hu!"
The maiden jumped and ran back to the kitchen pots.
She sat there saying, "This is not my affair."

They brought Lyanyaibungo, *Bull of the kalaito*.
They rubbed her with ashes and charcoal and burnt grass.
They said, "He won't know her now, Mugasha."

When they set her out in the reception room
Rushing-water came and picked her up.
He brought her to meet him on Nykilembeka beach.
He said, "That's the one, *welata welata*."

He said, "You've traveled far, *welata*."
They said, "Indeed."
He said, "You've travelled far, *welata*."
They said, "Indeed."
He said, "You've travelled far, *welata*."
They said, "Indeed."

He said, "And when you got there, did you meet Kagolo?,
Of the spirit shrine,
Of the water oracle, welata?"
They said, "We did not meet him there."

He said, "Paddle quickly!"
Don't you know Kagolo?
He comes to churn the lake up
While the children are still in the middle."

He said, "Paddle quickly, *welata*!
Don't you know Kagolo?
He comes to churn the lake up
While the children are still in the middle, *welata*."

Wo wo
Ya ya
We we we we
Ya ya
We we we we
Ya ya
We we we we
Ya ya

Omwaana kabamulesile omu isikilo ly' ekitalo,

Enjubu kayamulebile eti, "Ogu tiwe twaboine lushungu ogu!"
Enjubu kayalotokile eti, "Ha! ha! ha! hu! hu!"
Omwisiki yailuka yagaluka amugamba
Yashuntama ahi, "Tinyina bigambo."

Bamuleeta Lyanyaibungo, *Engundu y' akakalaito*.
Bamusiig' amakala eijwi nomuzilayonga.
Bati, "Tamumanye Mugasha."

[Bagya bamusha...] Olwo bakamuhumwize omu ibanga,
Yagya yamushutula Mushoke.
Yagya yamumushangis' omu mwaalo Nyakilembeka.
Ati, "Nawe, welata welata."

Ati, "Mwaiyukayo, welata."
Bati, "Eho."
Ati, "Mwaiyukayo, welata."
Bati, "Eho."
Ati, "Mwaiyukayo, welata."
Bati, "Eho."

Ahi, "Nawe bwemwatuka mwamala mwasangamu Kagolo
Komulwanga,
Kabyantabuuzi, welata?"
Bahi, "Titwamushangamu."

Ahi, "Buga bwangu!
Timumanyile Kagolo
Naija kufulungul' enyanja?
Abaana bali obuziba."

Ahi, "Buga bwangu, welata!
Timumanyile Kagolo
Naija kufulungul' enyanja?
Abaana bali obuziba walata."

Wo-wo
Ya-ya
We-we we-we
Ya-ya
We-we we-we
Ya-ya
We-we we-we
Ya-ya

POETIC STANZAS

249.1-250: 249.1-250.1: compound stanza in **aab**, 2 + 2 + 2, formed by contrast between couplets composed as repeated line + subject final line (**a**'s: 249.1-249.2, 249.3-249.4) and a single couplet of praisenames (**b**: 250-251).

250.2-252: 250.2-252.3: verse of three stanzas (250.2-250.5, 251-251.3, 252-252.3) in **aba** formed by two stanzas that cohere by lexical repetition and by stanzaic patterning as **ab**b**a** (**a**'s: 250.2-250.5, 252-252.3; formed internally by contrast between parallel lines of placenames (**b**'s: 250.3, 250.4 and 252.1, 252.2) and initial and final lines that cohere by past verbal tenses (**a**'s: 250.2, 250.5 and 252, 252.3)) contrasted with a single stanza in **abab**, (**b**: 251-251.3; formed internally by contrast between lines that cohere by grammatical subordination (**a**'s: 251, 251.2) and lines of praisenames (**b**'s:251.1, 251.3)).

He said, "Paddle quickly, *welata*!
Don't you know Kagolo?
He comes to churn the lake up
While the children are still in the middle, *welata*."

Ya ya
O o
Ya ya

He said, "Rushing-water, *Mpondele of fish lines*,
Nseli nkakabego ka kabantende
Tomali ngonatuka
Nkenseli nkakabego ka kabantende welata
Paddle quickly! Don't you know *Bwemwatuka*?

O o
Ya ya
We we
Ya ya

That day, my lord, Mugasha, I tell you,
He kept her inside for four-and-four-make-eight days.
That day he married her, the *trapper*.
He kept her in for four-and-four-make-eight days.
Suddenly, there appeared Kagolo,
.*Of the water oracle*,
Missile that causes envy,

He'd not been in.
He was in Buganda of Ntege and Kahimbo.
He was in Buzinza of Nshanshame
He had gone to trade, Kagolo.

When he returned, he asked his father Wamala,
Swaying-one of Nyante
He said, "Father, where is our child Lyanyaibungo,
Bull of the kalaito?"

He said, "Tell me, for I was away.
I was in Buganda of Ntege and Kihimbo.
I was in Buzinza of Nshanshame.
I had gone to trade."

Ati, "Buga bwangu, welata!
Timumanyile Kagolo
Naija kufulungul' enyanja?
Abaana bali obuziba, welata."

Ya-ya
O-o
Ya-ya

Ati, "Naiwe Misoke mpondele emigongo,
Nseli nkakabego ka kabantende
Tomali ngonatuka
Nkenseli nkakabego ka kabantende welata
Buga bwangu! Timumanyile bwemwatuka.

O-o
Ya-ya
We-we
Ya-ya

Kil' ekyo waitu, Mugasha, nkugambile,
Yamumazaamu ebilo bina na bina munana.
Kil' eky' amushweile *Njwenge*.
Yamumazaamu ebilo bina na bina munana.
Lyamuleeta Kagolo,
Kabyantabuuzi,
Luhuuba lwa kachubya

Akashangwa atalimu.
Ali Buganda bwa Ntege na Kihimbo.
Ali Buzinja bwa Nshanshame
Akaba agile kutunda Kagolo.

Kayaizile yabaza ishe Wamala,
Luyongo lwa Nyante.
Ati, "Tata alinkaha omwaana waitu Lyanyaibungo,
Engundu y' akakalaito?"

Ahi, "Mubaluulile okwo nabaile
Ndi Buganda bwa Ntege na Kihimbo.
Ndi Buzinja bwa Nshanshame
Nkaba ngiile kutuunda nye."

POETIC STANZAS

254-257: 254-257.1: stanza in **ab**bb**a** formed by contrast between lines that end with "my child" (**a**'s: 254, 257.1) and lines that begin with "See..." (**b**'s: 255, 256, 257).

259-270: 259-270: compound stanza in **aa**b**a** formed by the contrast between three linegroups, each comprised of a single exchange of quoted utterances asymmetrical in length (**a**'s: 259-261, 262-264, 268-270; in the final linegroup the answer is several lines in length, reversing the pattern of the previous linegroups) and a single linegroup that comprises multiple exchanges of quoted utterances symmetrical in length (**b**: 264.1-267).

We we

His father said, "My child,"
He said, "Just look at my plantation.
Look how even now the banana palms have not stood up."
He said, "Look also at the things Mugasha left,
My child,"

He said, "Those fish were once inside."
They were picking up and throwing out those left by the waters. [some indistinct words]
He said, "Father,"
He said, "I ask a question
What did you do then?"
He answered, "Mugasha took her."

He said, "Father,
I ask a single question–
On this earth how many kings are you?"
He said, "We are two: I and Mugasha."
He said, "And what do you rule, Wamala?"
He said, "I rule the land."
He said, "And Mugasha?"
He said, "He rules the lake."

He said, "Land or lake–which is greater?"
He said, "My child,
Land is the greater; lake, the smaller.."
And as Wamala said, I reckon that it's true:
Travellers to the Indian Ocean say the water rests entirely on the land.
Or is it in the air?
True or wrong?

Ewe we

He said, "My child land is the greater; water, the smaller, but he was . . ."
He said, "Give me leave to go after I recite my praise.
My mother's child cannot be married by the *fisherman of Ishulaine Bugunda*."

We-we

Ishe ati, "Mwaana wange,"
Ati, "Olebe ekibanja kyange, kyonka...
Olebe okwo nawaha engemu tikaimukile."
Ati, "Olebe n' ebintu ebyo yasigil' aha Mugasha,
Mwaana wange."

Ati, "Emfulu ezabaile zili munu."
Mbatwaala mbasheesha ezasigilw' amaizi.

Ahi, "Tata,"
Ahi, "Ninkubaz' ekigambo -
Okagilaki?"
Ahi, "Akamutwaala Mugasha."

Ahi, "Tata,
Ninkubaza ekigambo kimo -
Omu nsi mulimu abakama bangaha?"
Ahi, "Tuli babili: nanye na Mugasha."
Ahisi, "Notwaalaki Wamala?"
Ahi, "Nintwaal' eitaka."
Ahisi, "Mugasha?"
Ahi, "Natwaala enyanja."

Ahisi "Eitaka n' enyanja - ekingi kiki?"
Ishe ati, "Mwaana wange,
Eitaka nilyo lingi, enyanja nke."
Mala kayakigambile Wamala napima nti kwakweli:
Nabagy' omu mahanga bakagoba Indian Ocean bagila bati enyanja etula aitaka lwona.
Kandi eli angani?
Wongo kweli?

Ewe-we

Ahi, "Mwaana wange eitaka nilyo lingi enyanja nke kyonka aka..."
Ahi, "Tata, inye nsige nakwebugila."
Ahi, "Omwaana wa maawe tiyakushweelwa mujubi omwa Ishulaine Bugunda."

POETIC STANZAS

283.1-291: 283.1-291.1: passage of four linegroups (283.1-284.1, 285-286.1, 287-288.1, 289-291.1) in **aa**a**b** formed by linegroups that are each composed, with some variation, of three repeated lines (**a**'s: 283.1-284.1, 285-286.1, 287-288.1) contrasted with a single linegroup (**b**: 289-291.1) that begins like the others but ends differently.

292-299: 292-299.1: passage of four linegroups (292-293, 294-295, 296-297, 298-299) each each composed, with some variation, of three types of lines formed by repetition and parallelism.

He said, *"I am Kagolo*
Of the spirit shrine,
Of the water oracle,
Missile that causes envy,
I am dry words spoken in fury,
I, of the stiff elbows
All adorned in beads except the palm,
Of the left-handers,
Of the water oracle,"
He said, "*I drank it–I spilled it;*
I built it –I burned it,
Pouncer on warriors."

He said, "Give me my bow."
They gave him one of coffee wood.
When Kagolo went out to try it in the courtyard, it snapped.
He returned.

He grabbed one of *mulinzi* wood.
When he went out to the courtyard, it snapped.
Kagolo returned.

He grabbed one of *mutengo* wood.
When he went out to try it in the courtyard, it snapped
Kagolo returned.

He grabbed one of *mukanshe* wood.

Then he grabbed eight arrows.
The ninth went in his hand,
Making a clacking sound, "enjenje."

Along the path that took him were banana plants.
They were transformed to Raffia palms,
By the power of Kagolo.

When he reached the cattle road,
Mishunshu shrubs were transformed to *bijeela*,
By the power of Kagolo.

He reached a *mujumbo*.
It was transformed to a coffee tree,
By the power of Kagolo.

He arrived…
He arrived outside the village.
Shanje grass was transformed to *yojwe*,
By the power of Kagolo.

Ati, "Inye ndi Kagolo
Komulwanga,
"Kabyantabuuzi
Luhuuba lwa Kachubya,
Mba Butoto bwa Kyoomya,
Ndi w' enkokola zabaile igandami,
Buhunzile bwoona busigaiz' akaganja,
Bwa nyin' emosho,
Kabyantabuuzi,"
Ahi, *"Ngunywana ngushesha;*
Ngombeka ngokya,
Lutumbika manzi."

Ahi, "Mp' obuta bwange."
Bamuha obw' omumwaani.
Kayshohoile omu kibuga kulenga Kagolo,[yagu…]
gwahendeka.
Yagaluka.

Yakwaat' obw' omuti ogw' omulinzi.
Kayashohoile omu kibuga bwahendeka.
Kagolo yagaluka.

Yakwaat' obw' omutengo.
Kayashohoile kulenga omu kibuga bwahendeka
Kagolo yagaluka

Yakwaata ob' omukanshe.

Aho yakwaata emihambi munana.
Ogwa mwenda gwamugend' omu byaala
Ngugamba ejenjenje.

Mbali yatweetwe zili ngemu.
Zahinduka mihunge,
Obushobla bwa Kagolo.

Kayagobile omu kihongolelo
Emishunshu yahinduka bijeela,
Obushobola bwa Kagolo.

Yagoba amujumbo.
Gwahinduka mumwaani,
Obushobola bwa Kagolo.

Yagoba…
Yagoba ehelu.
Eshanje yahinduka yoojwe,
Obushobola bwa Kagolo.

NOTES

316 Looked over with one eye. To look at a person briefly, with the head turned making one eye prominent communicates a hostile, or at least not a friendly, disposition.

POETIC STANZAS

301-305: 301-305: compound stanza in **aab**, 2 + 2 + 1, formed by contrast between couplets composed as plant name + resembles + plant name/ repeated line (**a**'s: 301-302, 303-304) and a single line that begins the same but ends differently **b**: 305).

You see these plants resemble one another.

Banana tree resembles Raffia palm,
If you stand a way off from its dried foliage.
Mushunshu resembles *kijela*,
If you stand a way off from its dried foliage.
Mujumbo resembles coffee's dried foliage.

Ewewe iyoo
Ewewe iyoo

He went and stood on a boulder at Nyakilembeka.
He looked into the middle of the lake and saw Mugasha.
He was catching *bukeije* and *nkolongo* fish.
The helmsman of the canoe was Rushing-water.

Then, my lords, to concentrate my telling,
My friends, to make its details clear–
Kagolo stood in about this spot.
Mugasha was far off on the lake, like the distance to Itahwa. (several miles)

He looked and said, "If I let fly at him from here,
The arrows will not reach.
The wind will throw them off."

He called to him, "You, Mugasha,
Come and take me.
I would see our child Lyanaibungo,
Bull of the kalaito.
The reason being, I was not there.
I was in Buganda of Ntege and Kiimbo.
I was in Buzinza of Nshanshame.
I had gone to trade.
Now come and take me, please.
I would see our child Lyanyaibungo."

Mugasha trained one eye on him.
The helmsman of the canoe was Rushing-water.
He said, "Rushing-water of the Lake, *(puller) of fish lines*,
Olyatotombola welata
We've not finished and Kagolo
Comes to churn the lake up.
While the children are still in the middle."

Ewe wewe e

Mala ebintu ebyo mbishanangana.

Engemu neshana omuhunge.
Kowakweema hala ekibabi,
Omushunshu ngushan' ekijela.
Kowakwema hala ekibabi,
Omujumbo ngushan' omumwani ekibabi.

Ewewe iyoo
Ewewe iyoo

Yagya yayemeelela akibaale Nyakilembeka.
Akaleeba obuziba akabona Mugasha
Najuba obukeije n' enkolongo.
Ayabaile agobile obwato ni Mushoke.

Aho, waitu, okubagambila kubomesheza,
Batai baitu, kubimanyage,
Kagolo akaba ayemeleile nkahanu.
Egi yona eli nyanja kugoba nka Itahwa.

Yaleeba ati, "Kandamutaishulila,
Emihambi tegobeyo.
Omuyaga ngwija kuginaga."

Yamweeta ati, "Iwe Mugasha,
Oij' ontole.
Ndeebe omwaana waitu Lyanyaibungo,
Engundu y' akakalaito.
Kub' enshonga nkaba ntalimu.
Ndi Buganda bwa Ntege na Kihimbo.
Ndi Buzinja bwa Nshansname.
Nkaba ngiile kutuunda.
Mbwenu oij' ontole.
Ndeb' omwaana waitu Lyanyaibungo."

Mugasha akaleebayo limo.
Ayabaile agobile obwato ni Mushoke.
Ati, "Musoke enyanja *ely' emigongo*,
Olyatotombola welata.
Tituumalile Kagolo
Aija kufulungul' enyanja.
Abaana bali obuziba."

Ewe wewe-e

The canoe floated even further into the middle of the lake.
Now, it left Itahwa
And arrived at about Ibula or Magoti.
[Mugasha, there . . .]

When he saw that the canoe had floated off a bit,
Kagolo stood up on the rocky outcrop.
He truly let eight arrows fly,
But as they came over the lake,
The wind was tossing them about.
For the ninth, he lay prone upon the rock.
He let it fly
With all his strength, for it was the last one he had.
It travelled and it stuck in Mugasha's knee.

His own leg–Mugasha lopped it off.
He threw it in the lake.
He went inside the Mugoma rocky outcrop.
He brought out Lyanyaibungo,
Bull of the kalaito.

He said, "Let's go. I'll take you.
Your people have come for you."
He said, "I cannot marry you.
I am disfigured in my leg, Mugasha."

He said, "But for eight days I was married to you,
Lyanyaibungo,
Bull of the kalaito,
Should you bear a child, it would be mine."

When he took about two paddle strokes,
He felt great pain, the *trapper*.
He summoned thunder, *essential warrior*,
He said, "I would meet Kagolo at the landing.
He'll have no word to say."
He said, "But do not stop his heart."

When he let loose a single bolt,
It struck the solid rock–which split apart.
From the place Kagolo stood,
He sank suddenly into Kabyantabuzi rock.
Only his head and hands remained above.

Obwaato bwashuba bwailil' obuziba.
Mbwenu bwaluga nka Itahwa.
Bwagya nka Ibula anga Magoti.
[Mugash' aho...]

Kayaboine okwo obwaato bwaililayo
Kagolo ayemeleile alwazi.
Yataishula emihambi munana kwo,
Neij' omu nyanja,
Omuyaga nguginaga.
Ogwamwenda yabyama alwazi.
Yataishula muno
N'amani gona okuba bwasigala gumo.
Gwagenda Mugasha gwamukoz' okugulu.
Yechula ahi, "Nakozibwa enkolongo shana ezonkujuba."

Okugulu Mugasha yagutula,
Yanaga omunyanja.
Yataaha omukyazi ekya Mugoma,
Yamwiyamu Lyanyaibungo,
Engundu ya kakalaito.

Ahi, "Ija nkutwaale.
Ab'owanu bakuhondeile."
Ati, "Tinakukushweela.
Ndemaile kugulu Mugasha."

Ahi, "Kyonka omibilo munana nkushweile Lyanyaibungo,
Engundu ya kakalaito,
Kawakuzaala omwaana yakuba wange."

Kayabugilemu engahi nka ibili,
Yashaaliliwa, *Njwenge*.
Yabilikila Nkuba *Kanyalumanzi*,
Ahi, "Nshange Kagolo amwaalo.
Ataina kyakugamba."
Ahi, "Kyonka otakumalamu mwoyo."

Olwo yakailemu olulabyo lumoi,
Yateela eibale lyayatika.
Kagolo mbali yabaile ayemeeleile,
Yatobela omulwaazi Kabyantabuuzi
Eigulu yasigazayo omutwe n'emikono.

NOTES

348 Whoever hits your eye... is a well-known proverb.

When he reached there, Mugasha,
He said, "You, Kagolo,
Look, your family's child is here, Lyanyaibungo,
    Bull of the kalaito."
He answered, "Ti ti ti ti ti ti."
"Kagolo *of the spirit shrine*,
    I, Mugasha, have come."
    He said, "Ti ti ti ti ti."
With his paddle, Mugasha dealt Kagolo's head a blow–
    Which launched and freed him from Kabyantabuzi rock.

His word to Kagolo at the landing was this:
"Whoever hits you in the eye– you hit him in the nose."
Mugasha had just one leg to stand on.
And since that time what did Kagolo do?
He's never found a word to say.

Kayagobileho Mugasha,
Ati, "Iwe Kagolo,
Leeba, omwaana wanyu niwogu Lyanyaibungo,
    Engundu ya kakalaito."
Ati, "Ti ti ti ti ti ti."
"Kagolo *k'omulwanga*,
    Naizile Mugasha."
    Ati, "Ti ti ti ti ti."
Yamutel' engahi omumutwe Kagolo.
    Yalug' omulwaazi Kabyantabuuzi.

Ekigambo kyoyagambile amwaalo Kagolo akagil' ati:
"Akuteela elisho -- Omuteel' enyindo."
Mugasha akemeleza okugulu kumoi.
Namambwenu Kagolo akagilaki?
Takabonaga kyakugamba.